

SENATE JOINT RESOLUTION 368

By Southerland

A RESOLUTION to honor and commend Dr. Nicole Cardwell-Hampton on her being named the 2025 Tennessee Board of Regents Staff Member of the Year.

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should pause to specially recognize those outstanding administrators who have devoted their careers to providing the highest quality education for Tennessee's students; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Nicole Cardwell-Hampton is one such estimable educator, who has distinguished herself as a professional of the greatest dedication, ability, and integrity; and

WHEREAS, the director of youth programs in the Walters State Community College Division of Workforce Training, Dr. Cardwell-Hampton was recently named the 2025 Tennessee Board of Regents Staff Member of the Year, a most befitting honor for her tenure as an educator, as it recognizes the positive influence she has on so many young lives; and

WHEREAS, well-equipped in the expertise needed to best serve students, Dr. Cardwell-Hampton graduated from the University of Tennessee, Knoxville, with Bachelor of Science and Master of Science degrees, and she procured an educational specialist degree from Lincoln Memorial University and a Doctor of Education degree from East Tennessee State University; and

WHEREAS, joining Walters State Community College in 1997 as an associate professor of production horticulture, Dr. Cardwell-Hampton moved to the Division of Workforce Training in 2009 to manage the college's youth programs, through which she has coordinated non-crediting camps for youth for the local area; and

WHEREAS, since 2022, Dr. Cardwell-Hampton has focused her efforts on improving the summer camps that the division offers, increasing the number and quality of the camps and spreading them across all four campuses and the Newport Center; and

WHEREAS, the camps include such favorites as the underwater robotics program, which sees teams compete to design and construct the best underwater robot to test in local pools, and new creations such as the "Mini Medic" and "HAMtastic" programs, which teach campers about emergency medical procedure and radio technology respectively; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Cardwell-Hampton also oversees the Talented and Gifted Program, which hosts 350 students each year, and the Kids College summer program; through her indefatigable industriousness, she has secured sufficient grants from both national and regional organizations to allow many camps to run free of charge to their participants, opening horizons for local children that would otherwise be closed by financial barriers; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Nicole Cardwell-Hampton is an extremely talented and compassionate educator who has worked assiduously throughout her career in education to motivate her students and colleagues to reach their full potential as scholars, professionals, and citizens, and her infectious positivity serves her well when speaking to potential college recruits, as well as when serving on the Strategic Enrollment Management Committee and completing her myriad duties for the college; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Cardwell-Hampton truly serves as an inspiration to Walters State Community College and the ten counties it serves, and her friendship and counsel are highly valued by those who are fortunate to know her; and

WHEREAS, Dr. Nicole Cardwell-Hampton epitomizes the dedicated educator who is wholly committed to the highest ideals of public service and quality education for all, and she should be specially recognized; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE SENATE OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES CONCURRING, that we hereby honor and congratulate Dr. Nicole Cardwell-Hampton on being chosen as the 2025 Tennessee Board of Regents Staff Member of the Year, commend her exceptional service to the children of Tennessee, salute her professional expertise and personal excellence, and wish her all the best in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.